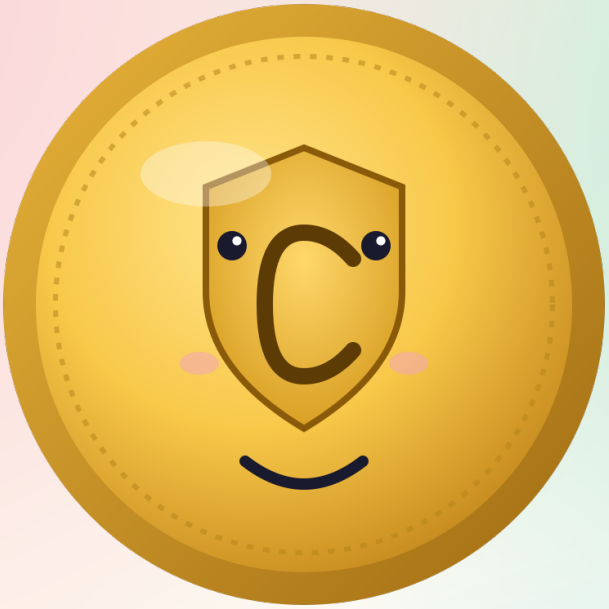


GRADE 2

Lesson Plans

C A S H

Businesses solve problems

Ten lessons that bring the year to life.

Grade 2 — Cash to Company: Lesson Plans

Ten lessons sampled across the year. Each lesson is 30–35 minutes — slightly longer than Grade K, slightly shorter than Grade 3. Every lesson follows the same skeleton: warm-up, mini-lesson, activity (the bulk of the time), and close. Most assessment is **observation-plus-artifact** — the teacher watches the move and the artifact (a Problem→Idea card, a sign, a checklist tick) goes in the child's folder.

The format below is the pattern for every lesson:

- **Objectives** (what a child can demonstrably do)
- **Standards** (one or two; copied from the Standards Alignment Map)
- **Materials**
- **Vocabulary** (1–3 words from the year's roadmap)
- **Procedure** (warm-up, mini-lesson, activity, close)
- **Differentiation** (ELL, IEP/504, advanced)
- **Assessment** (what the teacher watches for and what artifact lands in the folder)

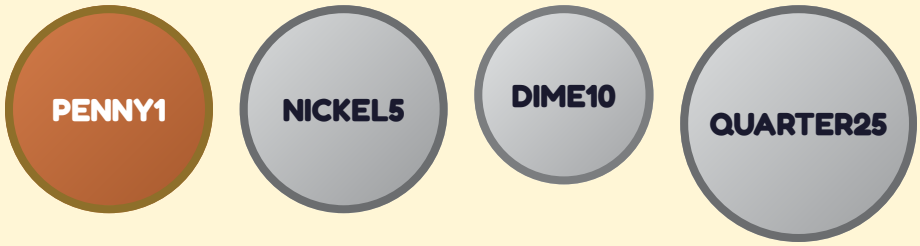
Lessons sampled:

1. (Week 1, Unit 1) The Problem Wall opens — Cash V1 launch
2. (Week 5, Unit 1) Match the problem to the helper

3. (Week 8, Unit 1) Problem → Idea card, first try — Cash V2
4. (Week 11, Unit 2) Make change from a dollar — Cash V3
5. (Week 16, Unit 2) Class Market day — change practice
6. (Week 20, Unit 3) Signs that help customers — Cash V5
7. (Week 24, Unit 3) Boss, worker, customer — the team skit — Cash V6
8. (Week 27, Unit 3) Was that fair? — fairness check — Cash V7
9. (Week 32, Unit 4) "What would you change?" — peer revision
10. (Week 36, Unit 4) The Solve-It Fair — Cash V8

Lesson 1 — The Problem Wall opens

Grade band: K-2 **Time:** 30 minutes **Unit:** 1 — Problems we see **Cash video tie-in:** V1 — "Hi Again, Friend"



Objectives

- Name one problem the child has noticed in school.
- Add a sticky note for that problem to the class Problem Wall.

Standards

- **NGSS-ETS K-2-ETS1-1:** Ask questions, make observations, and gather information about a situation people want to change.
- **CCSS-ELA W.2.2:** Write informative/explanatory texts.

Materials

- Cash Video #1 (2:00) on a screen.
- A blank bulletin board labeled **PROBLEM WALL**.
- A stack of large sticky notes (4x4 inches), one per child plus spares.
- Markers, one per pair.
- A class-circle rug.

Vocabulary

- **problem** — something that bothers us or makes a job hard.
- **idea** — a way to fix the problem.

Procedure

Warm-up — 4 min. Children gather on the rug. Teacher says: "Last year you noticed helpers. This year, we notice problems. A problem is a thing that bothers us. A problem is a thing a helper can fix." Take 2–3 examples — a missing pencil, a long lunch line. Children echo the word problem.

Mini-lesson — 6 min. Play Cash V1. Cash says hi, points at three problems Cash sees in a school: a stack of mismatched mittens, a pencil sharpener that jams, a kid who forgot a lunchbox. Cash names each one as a problem. Pause the video at the end. Ask: "What's a problem Cash saw?" Children call out. Teacher writes 3 on chart paper.

Activity — 16 min. Sticky-note round. Each child gets one sticky note. Teacher says: "Think of one problem in our school. Not at home. In our school. Where you have eyes on it." Children walk to a partner, say their problem out loud, and write a short version on the sticky (drawing is fine; the words can come from a partner or the teacher's hand). Children add their sticky to the Problem Wall. As they place each one, the teacher reads it aloud. Class hears the whole list.

Close — 4 min. Stand in front of the wall. Read the wall. Cheer (one clap each). Pick the first **Problem of the Week** by quick vote — fingers up for one of three the teacher reads. Teacher circles the chosen problem with a star.

Differentiation

- **ELL.** A drawing on the sticky is fully fine. The word is bonus.
- **IEP/504.** Pre-printed picture stickers (long line, missing item, broken thing). Child peels and places.
- **Advanced.** Add a second sticky: "who could fix this?" Push the child to name a person or kind of helper.

Assessment

Observation: child added a sticky to the Problem Wall (Y/N), child told a partner the problem in words or pointed (Y/N). **Artifact:** the sticky note (stays on the wall).

Lesson 2 — Match the problem to the helper

Grade band: K-2 **Time:** 30 minutes **Unit:** 1 — Problems we see

Objectives

- Match a problem to a real business that already solves a problem like it.
- Tell a partner why the match makes sense.

Standards

- **C3 D2.Eco.5.K-2:** Identify prices of products people pay for what they want.
- **CCSS-ELA W.2.2:** Write informative/explanatory texts.

Materials

- Card pairs:
- "Spilled juice" + "the paper towel store / a janitor"

- "Lost mittens" + "the mitten store"
- "Cold cereal in the morning" + "the bakery / the diner"
- "Tired feet at the playground" + "the shoe store"
- "Empty stomach at recess" + "the snack stand"
- Pocket chart or floor space.

Vocabulary

- **business** — a person or place that helps people, usually for money.

Procedure

Warm-up — 3 min. Hold up the "spilled juice" card. Ask: "Who fixes a spilled juice?" Children call out. Affirm: "A janitor fixes it. A paper towel store sells the towel. Both are helpers."

Mini-lesson — 5 min. Teacher: "Every problem has a helper. The helper is usually a kind of business. Today we match." Demonstrate one full match on the pocket chart. The class reads the pair aloud together: "Spilled juice — paper towel store."

Activity — 18 min. Pair work. Each pair gets a small set of 4 problem cards and 4 helper cards. They match. They tell each other: "This problem goes with this helper because..." Teacher walks. Confer with 4–5 pairs. As pairs finish, they bring their matches to the wall and add them to a "MATCHED" section under the Problem Wall.

Close — 4 min. Whole-class chant for three pairs: "Lost mittens — mitten store. Empty stomach — snack stand. Tired feet — shoe store." Children join the chant.

Differentiation

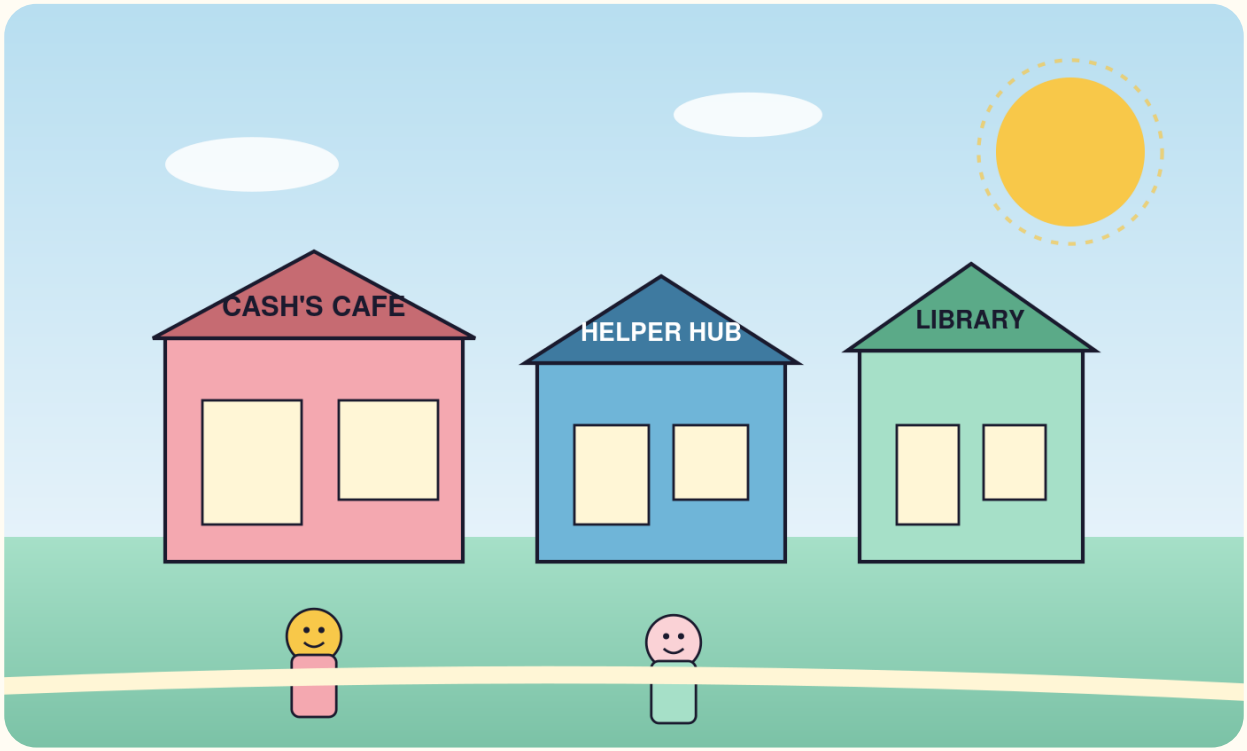
- **ELL.** Pictures-only matching is fully fine. Words are bonus.
- **IEP/504.** Pair child with peer-helper. Reduce field to 2 pairs at a time.
- **Advanced.** Add: "name two helpers for this problem." (e.g., spilled juice → janitor and paper towel store.)

Assessment

Observation: child matched at least 3 of 4 pairs (Y/N), child told the partner one reason in words (Y/N). **Artifact:** matched pairs on the wall (whole class).

Lesson 3 — Problem → Idea card, first try

Grade band: K-2 **Time:** 35 minutes **Unit:** 1 — Problems we see **Cash video tie-in:** V2 — "Problem, Then Idea"



Helpers are everywhere. Each one is a kind of business.

Objectives

- Fill out a Problem → Idea card naming one problem in school and one idea to fix it.
- Share the card with a partner.

Standards

- **NGSS-ETS K-2-ETS1-1:** Ask questions and gather information about a situation people want to change.
- **CASEL Responsible Decision-Making:** Identify a problem and propose a solution.

Materials

- Cash Video #2 (2:15).
- Problem → Idea card (index card, pre-lined): top half says PROBLEM, bottom half says IDEA. A small box for child's name.
- Pencils.
- The Problem Wall (already filled from earlier weeks).

Vocabulary

- **idea** — a way to fix a problem.

Procedure

Warm-up — 3 min. Children sit on the rug. Teacher reads three stickies from the Problem Wall. "Pick one problem in your head. Hold onto it."

Mini-lesson — 6 min. Play Cash V2. Cash holds up a card with two halves — top says PROBLEM, bottom says IDEA. Cash demonstrates: "Problem: the lunch line is too long. Idea: open a second line at the salad bar." Pause. Ask: "What was Cash's problem? What was Cash's idea?" Children call out. Show the actual card on chart paper.

Activity — 22 min. Each child fills in their card. Teacher walks. Confer with each child: "What's your problem? What's your idea?" Capture the child's words (the child writes if they can; the teacher writes on the line in light pencil if not). Children draw a small picture in the corner of

each half. When done, children pair up and read each other's cards out loud.

Close — 4 min. Three volunteers share with the whole class: "Problem... Idea..." Class claps once for each. Cards go in the child's folder. The teacher snaps a quick photo of each card for the assessment record.

Differentiation

- **ELL.** Drawing fills both halves of the card. Words come from a partner or the teacher's hand.
- **IEP/504.** Sentence frames stamped on the card: "Problem: ___ is too **. Idea: a ___ that** ."
- **Advanced.** Push: "What's a SECOND idea? Sometimes the first idea is not the best one."

Assessment

Observation: child shared the card with a partner out loud (Y/N). **Artifact:** the Problem → Idea card. **This is the year's first formal artifact** — keep it. The child will compare it to their final card in Week 36.

CASH SAYS

Which coin is more? Show me with your hands.

Lesson 4 — Make change from a dollar

Grade band: K-2 **Time:** 35 minutes **Unit:** 2 — Coins and change **Cash video tie-in:** V3 — "A Dollar and the Coins That Come Back"

Objectives

- Name how much change comes back from a dollar for a price under one dollar.
- Pick the right coins to make that change.

Standards

- **CCSS-Math 2.MD.C.8:** Solve word problems involving dollar bills, quarters, dimes, nickels, and pennies.
- **Jump$tart Standard 6, Benchmark 4-1:** Identify costs and benefits of a financial decision.

Materials

- Cash Video #3 (2:15).

- Pretend dollar bills (paper, one per pair).
- Coin cards (laminated, mixed). Each pair gets a small handful — at least 4 quarters, 6 dimes, 6 nickels, 10 pennies.
- A "change mat" — a 10x14 paper showing PRICE on the left, DOLLAR in the middle, CHANGE on the right.
- A Cash chart on the wall: Penny=1, Nickel=5, Dime=10, Quarter=25, Dollar=100.

Vocabulary

- **change** — the coins that come back when you pay more than the price.
- **dollar** — a paper bill worth one hundred cents.

Procedure

Warm-up — 4 min. Hold up a pretend dollar. "This is a dollar. A dollar is one hundred cents." Hold up a quarter. "What is this?" Children: "A quarter, twenty-five cents." Teacher: "How many quarters in a dollar?" Children count: "One, two, three, four. Four quarters." Repeat with dimes (ten dimes in a dollar), then nickels (twenty nickels in a dollar) — light touch, no pressure.

Mini-lesson — 7 min. Play Cash V3. Cash demonstrates one full change-making move. "The pretzel costs sixty cents. I pay with a dollar. How much comes back? Forty cents. What coins make forty cents? A quarter and a dime and a nickel — twenty-five plus ten plus

five — forty." Pause. On chart paper, write: 60 + 40 = 100. Underneath: 40 = 25 + 10 + 5.

Activity — 20 min. Pair work. Each pair gets a change mat, a dollar, and a handful of coins. The teacher calls out a price: "Round 1: pretzel costs 75¢. How much change?" Each pair places a dollar in the middle, the price in cents on the left (using coin cards or just writing), and the change coins on the right. The pair calls out the answer. Teacher confirms or coaches. Run 5 rounds, each with a different price under a dollar (75¢, 60¢, 45¢, 33¢, 10¢ — easy to hardest). Children rotate who lays out the coins.

Close — 4 min. Whole-class chant: "A dollar is one hundred. The price is what we pay. The change is what comes back." Repeat once. Teacher hangs the chart on the wall (it stays up the rest of the year).

Differentiation

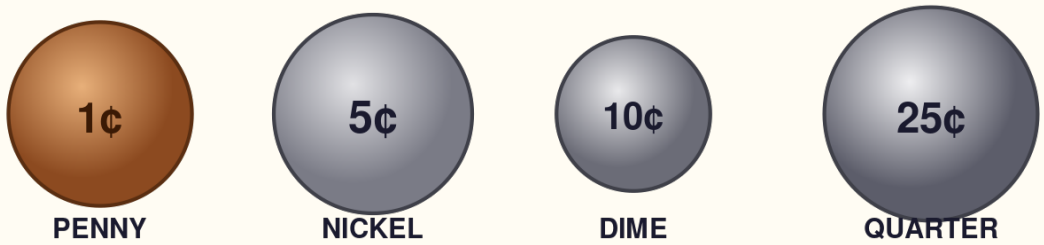
- **ELL.** Coin chart with dots stays visible. The math is universal.
- **IEP/504.** Use only "round" prices first (50¢, 75¢, 25¢) where the change is one or two coins. Build up over the unit.
- **Advanced.** Add: "What's another way to make 40¢?" (Four dimes. Two dimes and four nickels. Etc.)

Assessment

Observation: child placed correct change in 3 of 5 rounds (Y/N), child explained the math out loud once (Y/N). **Artifact:** the change mat (snapshot photo).

Lesson 5 — Class Market day

Grade band: K-2 **Time:** 40 minutes (longer block — this is a small capstone for Unit 2) **Unit:** 2 — Coins and change



Penny. Nickel. Dime. Quarter. We say each name out loud.

Objectives

- Set up a "store station" using a checklist.
- Make change from a dollar for a partner-customer.

Standards

- **CCSS-Math 2.MD.C.8:** Word problems with dollar bills and coins.
- **CEE Standard 2 (Buying Goods and Services), Grade 4:** People consider what they want and what they can afford.

Materials

- 6–8 small "store stations" around the room (a table or floor space each).
- Per station: a paper sign with the store name (snack stand, sticker shop, pet shop, etc.), 5–8 paper goods with hand-written prices (under $1), a set of coin cards, a paper dollar.
- A **Setup Checklist** (one per station): (1) sign up, (2) goods out, (3) prices on, (4) coins in the drawer, (5) ready to open.
- A small bell or chime.

Vocabulary

- **checklist** — a list of steps you check off as you go.

Procedure

Warm-up — 4 min. "Today, our room is a market. You will be both. Sometimes shopkeeper. Sometimes customer. The shopkeeper makes change."

Mini-lesson — 6 min. Demonstrate the setup checklist at one station with the whole class watching. "Step 1: sign up. Step 2: goods out. Step 3: prices on. Step 4: coins in the drawer. Step 5: ready to open." Tick each box on the checklist. Ring the bell when ready.

Activity — 25 min. In pairs of 3 (one shopkeeper, two customers — rotate every 6 minutes). Children at each station first follow the checklist together (3 minutes). Teacher rings the bell to open the

market. Customers walk to a station, point at one good, hand over a dollar, and the shopkeeper hands back the right change. Three transactions per pair, then rotate. Teacher walks the room. Confer with shopkeepers — "How did you know it was forty cents?" Confer with customers — "Was that the right change?"

Close — 5 min. Whole-class debrief. "What was hard? What was easy?" Take 4–5 answers. Teacher hangs the **Class Market** photo on the wall later that week.

Differentiation

- **ELL.** The change mat from Lesson 4 stays at every station as a scaffold.
- **IEP/504.** Pair child with a strong peer. Child can be the customer (handing over the dollar) without the change-making pressure. Mark Y on customer-role.
- **Advanced.** "Manager" role — child walks the room with a clipboard, checks one other station's checklist, gives a thumbs-up or asks a kind question.

Assessment

Observation: child completed the setup checklist (Y/N), child made correct change at least once as shopkeeper (Y/N), child used kind words (Y/N). **Artifact:** completed setup checklist (one per station; goes in the cumulative folder).

Lesson 6 — Signs that help customers

Grade band: K-2 **Time:** 35 minutes **Unit:** 3 — Signs, teams, and fair play **Cash video tie-in:** V5 — "Signs Are Helpers Too"

Objectives

- Draw a sign that helps a customer (open/closed, line forms here, today's special).
- Tell a partner why the sign helps.

Standards

- **CCSS-ELA W.2.2:** Write informative/explanatory texts.
- **C3 D2.Eco.2.K-2:** Identify goods and services in the community.

Materials

- Cash Video #5 (2:15).
- 8.5x11 paper, one per child.
- Markers, crayons.
- Three example signs on the board: OPEN, LINE FORMS HERE, TODAY'S SPECIAL: Apples 25¢.
- The class **Sign Library** wall (a new bulletin board section).

Vocabulary

- **sign** — a picture or words that tell a customer something.

Procedure

Warm-up — 3 min. Show three real-life sign photos: a coffee shop "OPEN," a grocery line tape, a "Today's Special" chalkboard. Ask: "Why are signs helpful?" Children answer.

Mini-lesson — 7 min. Play Cash V5. Cash shows three signs. Cash names what each sign tells the customer. "Open means come in. Line forms here means stand here. Today's special tells you what's new and how much it costs." Pause. Ask: "What sign did Cash show?" Children echo.

Activity — 20 min. Each child picks a kind of business (snack stand, pencil shop, lost-and-found, library, dentist) and draws one sign for it. Constraints: (1) one big picture or symbol, (2) one short message, (3) clear so a customer at the back of the room can read it. Teacher walks. As children finish, the sign goes on the **Sign Library** wall. Each child reads their sign aloud to a partner: "This is for the **. It says** . It helps the customer because ___."

Close — 5 min. Walk the room as a "sign tour." Teacher reads four random signs aloud. Class claps once for each.

Differentiation

- **ELL.** A picture-only sign is fully fine (an arrow, a face, an item). Words are bonus.
- **IEP/504.** Pre-printed sign templates (with one phrase already on it). Child colors and adds the picture.

- **Advanced.** Add a second sign for the same business — different message (open and closed, or special and regular price).

Assessment

Observation: child explained why the sign helps in their own words (Y/N). **Artifact:** the sign — stays on the **Sign Library** wall and is photographed for the folder.

Lesson 7 — Boss, worker, customer (the team skit)

Grade band: K-2 **Time:** 30 minutes **Unit:** 3 — Signs, teams, and fair play **Cash video tie-in:** V6 — "Three Jobs on a Team"

Objectives

- Identify the boss, the worker, and the customer in a classroom skit.
- Say what each one does.

Standards

- **CASEL Relationship Skills:** Cooperation, role identification.
- **CCSS-ELA SL.2.1:** Participate in collaborative conversations.

Materials

- Cash Video #6 (2:15).
- Three paper labels on lanyards: BOSS, WORKER, CUSTOMER.
- A small skit setup: a counter, one item to "sell" (a paper apple), a pretend coin.
- Class circle space.

Vocabulary

- **boss** — the helper who decides what the team does.
- **worker** — the helper who does the job.
- **team** — a group of people working together.

Procedure

Warm-up — 3 min. "Today, we run a team. Three jobs. Each one is important."

Mini-lesson — 6 min. Play Cash V6. Cash demonstrates a 30-second skit with three Cash-puppets, each labeled. "The boss says: 'Today we sell apples for fifty cents.' The worker says: 'Yes, here's an apple, fifty cents please.' The customer says: 'Please, may I have an apple? Here's my coin.'" Pause the video. Ask: "What did the boss do? What did the worker do? What did the customer do?" Children answer.

Activity — 18 min. Three children at a time, each wearing one lanyard. Teacher coaches the lines: - BOSS: "Today we sell ___ for ___

cents." - WORKER: "Yes, here's a ___. ___ cents please." - CUSTOMER: "Please, may I have a ___?"

Run the skit 6–8 times with rotating children. After every two rounds, swap labels — every child should land in each role at least once across this lesson and the next two weeks.

Close — 3 min. Recap. "Three jobs. Boss decides. Worker does. Customer buys. Each one is a helper." Children recite the three lines once together.

Differentiation

- **ELL.** Sentence frames on a card the child holds up while speaking.
- **IEP/504.** Allow the customer role first (one short line). Build to worker, then boss across the next sessions. Mark each role landed on the checklist.
- **Advanced.** Add the question: "What if the boss and the worker disagree? What should they do?" Accept any kind, fair answer.

Assessment

Observation: child took at least one role and said the line (Y/N), child correctly named the three roles when asked (Y/N). **Artifact:** the lanyards (props; not a paper artifact this lesson).

CASH SAYS

What comes first? What comes next?

Lesson 8 — Was that fair? (the fairness check)

Grade band: K-2 **Time:** 30 minutes **Unit:** 3 — Signs, teams, and fair play **Cash video tie-in:** V7 — "Fair to the Customer"

Objectives

- Listen to a short story about a kid business and decide whether it was fair to the customer.
- Give one reason for the answer.

Standards

- **CASEL Responsible Decision-Making:** Evaluate the consequences of a decision.
- **CCSS-ELA RL.2.1:** Ask and answer questions to demonstrate understanding of a text.

Materials

- Cash Video #7 (2:15).
- Three short read-aloud "fairness stories" written by the teacher. Examples:
- **Story A:** "Maya runs a lemonade stand. She charges 25¢. Her cup is small but she fills it all the way." (Fair.)
- **Story B:** "Jonas runs a cookie stand. He charges 50¢. He gives his friend two cookies and his neighbor one cookie for the same price." (Not fair — same price, different amount.)
- **Story C:** "Priya runs a bracelet stand. She says her bracelets are silver. They are plastic painted silver." (Not fair — the story is not honest.)
- A "FAIR" card and a "NOT FAIR" card per child.

Vocabulary

- **fair** — honest and the same for everybody.

Procedure

Warm-up — 3 min. Ask: "What does fair mean?" Take 2–3 answers. Steer toward: "the same for everybody, and honest."

Mini-lesson — 6 min. Play Cash V7. Cash reads two short fairness stories aloud and asks the audience to vote. "Was that fair to the customer? Why?" Cash names the rule: "Fair means honest and the

same for everybody. No tricks." Pause. Ask: "What's Cash's rule?" Class repeats.

Activity — 18 min. Teacher reads Story A, B, C aloud, one at a time. After each, count down: "Three, two, one — show your card." Children hold up FAIR or NOT FAIR. Teacher calls on 2–3 children: "Tell me your reason." Children answer (one sentence is fine). Teacher records the room's vote on the board next to each story. After all three stories, group debrief — "Which story was the trickiest to decide? Why?"

Close — 3 min. Class chant: "Fair is honest. Fair is the same. Fair is the deal."

Differentiation

- **ELL.** Picture cards with each story scene help carry the meaning.
- **IEP/504.** Card-only response (no spoken reason required); the teacher acknowledges the card vote.
- **Advanced.** Push: "What could Jonas do to make the cookie stand fair?" (Same number of cookies for the same price.)

Assessment

Observation: child held up the correct card for at least 2 of 3 stories (Y/N), child gave one reason out loud (Y/N). **Artifact:** none this lesson — pure observation.

Lesson 9 — "What would you change?" (peer revision)

Grade band: K-2 **Time:** 35 minutes **Unit:** 4 — The Solve-It Fair

Objectives

- Show a Problem → Idea card to a classmate and ask "what would you change?"
- Write the classmate's answer on the back of the card.

Standards

- **CCSS-ELA SL.2.1:** Participate in collaborative conversations with peers.
- **NGSS-ETS K-2-ETS1-3:** Analyze data from tests of two objects designed to solve the same problem (light touch — comparing two ideas).

Materials

- Each child's Problem → Idea card from Lesson 3 (**now revised at least once during the unit**).
- A pencil per child.
- A sentence frame card on every desk: "What would you change?" and "They said: ___."

Vocabulary

- **revise** — to change something to make it better.

Procedure

Warm-up — 3 min. Hold up the year's earliest Problem → Idea card (snapshot from Lesson 3). "Remember when we started? Today we make our card better. We ask a classmate."

Mini-lesson — 6 min. Demonstrate. Teacher holds up a sample card (or a child's, with permission). Reads it aloud. Asks a volunteer child: "What would you change?" Child answers. Teacher writes the answer on the back of the card under the words "They said:" Class watches. Teacher repeats the move once more.

Activity — 22 min. Pair work. Each child shows their card to a partner, reads it aloud, asks the question. The partner gives one suggestion. Both children write the suggestion on the back of each other's card. Then each pair joins another pair (groups of 4) and repeats with a new partner — every child gets two suggestions on the back of their card.

Close — 4 min. Three volunteers share: "My idea was **. My partner said: change** . I might do that because ___." Class claps once for each. Cards return to the folder, ready for the Solve-It Fair.

Differentiation

- **ELL.** Drawing on the back is fully fine. The teacher captures the words in adult handwriting if needed.
- **IEP/504.** Sentence frame stamped on the card. Allow non-verbal response — the partner draws what they would change.
- **Advanced.** Push: "Pick which suggestion you'll actually try at the fair, and why." The child marks one of the two with a star.

Assessment

Observation: child asked the question (Y/N), child wrote (or had written) at least one suggestion on the back (Y/N). **Artifact:** the revised Problem → Idea card with at least 1 "they said" note. **This is the year's strongest single artifact.** It pairs with the original from Lesson 3 to show growth.

Lesson 10 — The Solve-It Fair (Showcase)

Grade band: K-2 **Time:** 40 minutes **Unit:** 4 — The Solve-It Fair (Capstone — Family Visit Day) **Cash video tie-in:** V8 — "Show a Grown-up Your Idea"

Objectives

- Present the Problem → Idea card to a grown-up.

- Read the "they said" note aloud and tell the grown-up which change the child plans to try.

Standards

- **CCSS-ELA SL.2.4:** Tell a story or recount an experience with appropriate facts and relevant details.
- **CASEL Self-Awareness:** Recognize one's own strengths and growth.

Materials

- The full Problem Wall.
- The Sign Library wall.
- Each child's Problem → Idea card (revised, with peer notes).
- A small "Solve-It Fair" booth setup at each child's desk (a folded card stand, a sign with the child's name, the Problem → Idea card propped up).
- A small badge sticker per child after they share.
- Class market goods leftover from Unit 2 — to play one round at the back of the room.

Vocabulary

- **share** — to tell someone what you made.

Procedure

Warm-up — 4 min. Greet families in a circle. Children sit at their booths, families circulate. Cash V8 plays on a screen: Cash welcomes families and says, "the kids saw problems all year. They had ideas. They asked classmates. Today they show you. Listen with your eyes."

Mini-lesson — 4 min. Teacher demonstrates with one volunteer child. "This is my problem. This is my idea. My classmate said I should change **. I think I will try that because** ." The grown-up says: "Thank you for telling me."

Activity — 25 min. Children stand at their booths. Each grown-up rotates through 3–4 booths, listening to each child read the card. Each child gets a badge sticker after sharing. After 15 minutes, families flow to the **Class Market** corner. Each child plays one round — one transaction with their grown-up using a paper dollar and the child making change. The teacher and any visiting volunteers help.

Close — 6 min. Whole-class farewell. Class chant: "We saw problems. We made ideas. We asked. We changed. We shared." Three children stand up and tell the class one thing they liked about the fair. Cash waves on screen. Families wave back.

Differentiation

- **ELL.** Family members may speak any language with their child. The card is the artifact; the telling can be in any language.

- **IEP/504.** A child who freezes can have the teacher read the card aloud while the child points. Counts as completed.
- **Advanced.** Add: "What would I add to my idea if I had one more month?" The child writes the addition on the card right before sharing.

Assessment

Final checklist (year-end): named at least one problem (Y/N), made a Problem → Idea card (Y/N), made change from a dollar at the market round (Y/N), drew a helpful sign (Y/N), took a role in the team skit at some point (Y/N), gave a fairness reason (Y/N), asked "what would you change" (Y/N), shared at the fair (Y/N). **This is the year's culminating observation.** All eight strand outcomes touched. **Artifact:** revised Problem → Idea card with peer notes, plus the original from Lesson 3 — paired in the cumulative folder.

Notes on the lessons not shown

The remaining ~26 weekly blocks recycle these patterns:

- **Problem Wall maintenance.** Add 1–2 new stickies per week. Read the wall at the start of each block. Pick a Problem of the Week on Fridays.
- **Coin moment.** A 5-minute "make-change-from-a-dollar" ritual on Tuesdays during Units 2–4.

- **Sign Library growth.** A new sign per child every 4 weeks during Unit 3, posted on the wall.
- **Team skit rotation.** Each of weeks 22–27 runs a 10-minute boss/worker/customer skit; rotate children so every child lands in each role.
- **Cash video viewings.** Each of the eight Cash videos lands once. Re-watch one short Cash video per week as a brain-break.

Teachers may sub in any picture book the school library has that fits the week's theme. Anchor texts in the Curriculum Book are a starting list, not a required list.

CASH SAYS

Tell me what they said with their words.

Year-end teacher reflection (3 questions)

After the Solve-It Fair, the teacher writes 3–5 sentences answering:

- Which lesson did the children carry the most? (Use the checklist data.)
- Which strand outcome was hardest for the room as a whole? Why?

- What would I change for next year? (One specific change.)

This is the program's smallest LRCI move, modeled at the teacher level — exactly the same "what would you change?" question we've been asking the kids.

Unit-by-unit overviews

Unit 1 — Problems we see (Weeks 1–9)

Spine. Build the noticing habit. Open the Problem Wall. Children should be able to (1) name 2–3 problems in our school, (2) match a problem to a real business that solves a problem like it, and (3) fill out their first Problem → Idea card by Week 9.

Daily routine. Begin every block with: "What problem did somebody solve for us this morning?" Take 3–5 answers. Add one new sticky per Tuesday.

Read-alouds. What Do You Do With a Problem?, Those Shoes, Last Stop on Market Street.

Cash videos in this unit. V1 (Hi Again, Friend — Week 1), V2 (Problem, Then Idea — Week 8).

Unit 2 — Coins and change (Weeks 10–18)

Spine. Make change from a dollar with mixed coins. Use a checklist to set up a store station.

Daily routine. Add a 5-minute "change moment" on Tuesdays: teacher calls a price, children show the coins.

Cash videos in this unit. V3 (A Dollar and the Coins That Come Back — Week 11), V4 (The Class Market — Week 16).

Unit 3 — Signs, teams, and fair play (Weeks 19–27)

Spine. Draw a helpful customer sign. Take each role in a boss/worker/customer skit. Decide whether a story is fair to the customer and give a reason.

Daily routine. A 5-minute "fairness check" on Fridays. Teacher reads a one-paragraph story; children hold up FAIR or NOT FAIR cards.

Cash videos in this unit. V5 (Signs Are Helpers Too — Week 20), V6 (Three Jobs on a Team — Week 24), V7 (Fair to the Customer — Week 27).

Unit 4 — The Solve-It Fair (Weeks 28–36)

Spine. Revise the Problem → Idea card. Ask one classmate "what would you change?" Show a grown-up at the fair.

Daily routine. Pair-and-share with the cards on Wednesdays. Teacher rotates pairings.

Cash videos in this unit. V8 (Show a Grown-up Your Idea — Week 36).

A short FAQ for first-time Grade 2 teachers

My class can't sit still for 35 minutes. What do I cut? Cut the warm-up. Keep the mini-lesson short. The activity is the lesson; protect it.

A child names a "problem" that's actually a private hardship. Receive warmly. Write it on a small private note for the teacher folder. Pick a different problem with the child for the public Problem Wall. Don't discuss the private one in front of the class.

A child can already make change easily. Push them to "another way" — make 40¢ with no quarters, or with all nickels. The math thinking is the lesson, not the speed.

The Problem Wall fills up. Good. Take photos. Roll the oldest stickies into a "history" folder. Keep adding.

A child won't take a turn at the team skit. Don't push. Let them watch. By the third week, most join. If never, give them the customer line only — one short phrase. Counts.

A pair argues about whether something was "fair." That's the work. Let them argue for 2 minutes. Then ask: "What's the rule?" Steer back to honest, the same for everybody.

The Solve-It Fair feels chaotic on the day. It will. That's normal. The rotation through booths and the market round will self-organize once families arrive.

How to use the class checklist (assessment crib sheet)

The class checklist is one page. Down the left: every child's name. Across the top: the year's eight strand outcomes, written in kid-friendly form:

1. Names a problem and a helper for it.
2. Filled out a Problem → Idea card and shared it.
3. Made change from a dollar.
4. Drew a helpful customer sign.
5. Used the setup checklist at the Class Market.
6. Took at least one role in the team skit (boss/worker/customer).
7. Gave a fair-to-customer reason.
8. Asked a classmate "what would you change?" and wrote down the answer.

Mark Y when you see a child do it. The checklist is the year's gradebook, used for the family conference. By June, every child should have most boxes checked. If a box is empty for 4+ children, repeat the lesson.

CASH SAYS

Notice, notice, notice. What did you see?

Senior expert upgrade pack — Common Misconceptions and classroom moves (Grade 2)

Common Misconceptions table

Kid belief	What's actually true	How to coach
"Making change means counting down from a dollar."	Most cashiers count up from the price. $0.67 → 70¢ (3 pennies) → $1 (3 dimes). Easier and less error-prone.	Demonstrate both ways. Children try both. Most pick "count up" within a week.
"If the item is 67 cents, you give 67 cents back."	The customer paid more than the item costs (a dollar). The change is the difference.	Lay out a real dollar and a 67-cent toy. "What did the customer give? What does the item cost? What's left to give back?"
"A problem is something you complain about."	A problem is something you can describe — and maybe solve. Complaining is venting; describing is the first step in business thinking.	"Tell me the problem in one sentence. No words about being mad. Just what's happening."
"If a sign is colorful, it works."	A sign that's clear works. Open. Closed. Line forms here. Color is bonus, not the point.	Show two signs: one beautiful but vague, one ugly but clear. "Which one helps a customer more? Why?"
"If I came up with the idea, my idea is the best one."	Ideas get better when many ideas come together. The first idea is rarely the final idea.	"What if we put your idea and your friend's idea together? Does it get stronger?"

Classroom-tested moves (Grade 2)

If a student names "a problem" that's actually about another student: redirect. "That sounds like a feeling about a friend, not a school problem. Can you name a problem about a thing or a place? What's hard at school for everyone?"

If a student gets stuck on "making change from a dollar": drop to nearest dime. Practice 70¢, 50¢, 30¢, 10¢. Once those are automatic, return to the harder odd-cent prices.

If two students disagree about whose idea is best: pick a third student to summarize both ideas. "Tell me what each idea was." Then class votes. Both children get heard.

If a student says "this is dumb, business stuff is for adults": validate, then re-frame. "Adults are just kids who got bigger. The skills you're building now are real. What's something you're good at right now?"

ROUND 2 PATCH — Common Misconceptions (Grade 2)

Common kid-belief	Reality	Coaching move
"When making change from a dollar, count down from 100."	Make-change works easiest when you count up from the price to the dollar.	Demonstrate: item costs 73¢. Count up: "73... 74, 75 (penny, penny), 80 (nickel), 85, 90, 95, $1.00 (4 nickels)" — or simpler: 75 (2 pennies), 100 (1 quarter). Practice both ways; let students choose.
"If I forget the penny, its only off by one cent."	Off by one cent is still wrong. The customer notices. Honest businesses get the change exactly right.	Run a "honest cashier" skit. The cashier is short one cent. Ask: "Is this fair to the customer? What should the cashier do?"
"A problem is just a thing I dont like."	A business problem is a thing that someone would pay to fix. "I dont like Tuesday" isnt a business problem. "My shoes get wet when it rains" is.	Sort 6 problem cards into "business problem" or "feeling problem." Affirm both matter; only one starts a business.
"The store sets the price by guessing."	The store sets the price based on what the item costs them and what customers will pay.	Use the bakery story: "The baker buys flour. The flour costs money. The bread has to be priced higher than the flour, or the baker loses money." Repeat: "Cost. Price. Cost. Price."
"If the line is long, the store is doing well."	Sometimes a long line means too few helpers.	Show two pictures: "Line of 4" vs. "Line of 30." Ask: "Which line will

Common kid-belief	Reality	Coaching move
	Long lines can lose customers who walk away.	lose customers?" Discuss the staffing fix.

ROUND 2 PATCH — Multi-Class Branching Scenario (Grade 2)

"The lunch line is too long." A 5-day branching scenario that practices PSIG + CBM + LTO + ESL.

- **Day 1.** Pose the problem. The class generates 5 ideas (a longer counter, a separate snack station, pre-made bags, a second cashier, online ordering). Write all 5 on the board.
- **Day 2.** The class votes for one to dramatize. Use a "fist-of-five" or sticky-dot vote.
- **Day 3-4.** Build the chosen idea into a 5-step setup checklist. Make a customer-helping sign.
- **Day 5.** Run the chosen idea as a Solve-It Fair station. Three classmates play "customers." Did the line go faster? Was it fair? Was it honest?

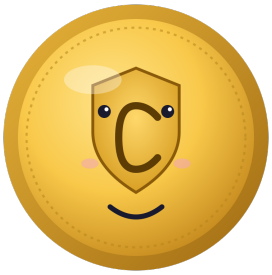
This branching scenario practices problem-spotting, ideation, voting, sequencing, signage, and post-action review — all in one arc.

CASH

Which people, and how do you know?

ROUND 2 PATCH — Teacher Move Set (Grade 2)

- **Student names a problem thats actually about another student** ("Jordan was mean at recess"). Say: "Thats a feeling problem with another person. Lets handle that with a teacher conversation. Today were looking for business problems — things someone would pay to fix. Can you think of one?"
- **Student counts down for change.** Say: "Both ways work. Lets try counting up — its faster for big bills." Demonstrate.
- **Student says "the store sets the price by guessing."** Say: "Lets check. The bakery buys flour for $2. They sell a loaf for $4. The loaf has to cost the bakery less than $4, or the bakery loses money. The price comes from the cost, plus what the customer will pay."
- **Student insists their problem is the only problem.** Say: "Lots of customers have lots of problems. Lets list 5 — yours and four others. Which one would the most people pay to fix?"
- **Student forgets to check the customer-helping signage.** Say: "If a customer walked in right now, would they know what to do? Look at your sign with customer eyes."



Which people, and how do you know?

— CASH

CASH TO COMPANY

Which people, and how do you know?

Cash is the friendly coin who helps us notice, ask, and try again. Cash will be with us all year. — Grade 2